



Brand guide

The short version of the Don't Be Michael design system, for anyone making something with the brand: a slide, a sticker, a partner page, a new screen. The full rules are in DESIGN.md in this folder.

EDITION 2026-09-24

Michael kept every job on his own desk.

He delegated nothing that mattered and called it leadership. Don't Be Michael is the office he should have run: a team of AI agents that does the work, while the owner signs off on it.

Everything the brand makes should say one of two things: **the work is delegated**, or **you stay in control by approving it**.

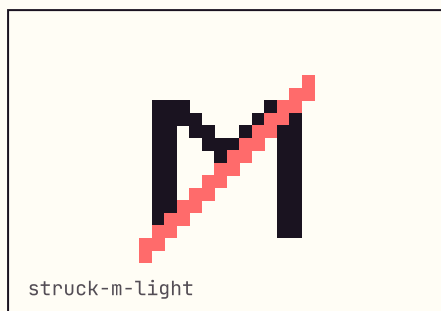
ONE FAMILY, TWO VOLUMES

	THE APP	THE WEBSITE AND MARKETING
Job	A workspace people sit in all day	A page that has to earn attention in seconds
Volume	Calm: muted colors, Inter text, thin lines	Loud: bright colors, pixel headlines, chunky frames
Shared	The logo, the cream and ink neutrals, the six color hues and what they mean, the hard offset shadow, the voice	

Rule of thumb: **anything outside the app is the website's volume**. Slides, social posts, merch and partner pages use the loud palette.

The Struck M

A pixel M with a coral slash through it. Read it as "don't be M". It is built on a 16 × 16 pixel grid and is always drawn as square pixels, never smoothed.



COLORS ARE FIXED

M in ink #1A1320 (cream #FFFDF5 on dark). Slash always coral #FF6B6B. The logo never changes color with a theme.

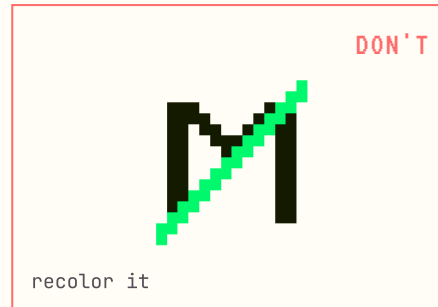
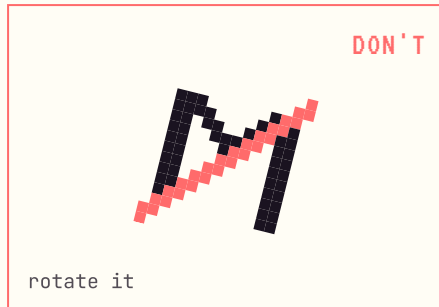
SIZE

Smallest: 16 px. Use sizes that are multiples of 16 (32, 48, 64 and up) or the SVG, so every pixel stays square and sharp.

CLEAR SPACE

Keep 2 grid cells (1/8 of the mark's width) empty on every side. Nothing else goes inside that margin.

Leave the mark alone.



- Don't stretch it, outline it, or redraw the slash as a smooth line.
- Don't use a character portrait, a necktie or a rubber stamp as the logo. Those ideas were tried and retired.
- Don't use NBC or *The Office* logos, title lettering, cast photos or likenesses anywhere. Michael is an archetype, not a licensed character.

Six hues, two volumes.

Each hue means the same thing everywhere. The website uses the bright set. The app uses the calm set of the same hues.

NEUTRALS (BOTH)

cream-50 #FFFDF5	cream-100 #FFF8E7	cream-200 #F4E9C7	cream-300 #E8D9A0	paper-100 #FCFAF0	paper-200 #F0EAD2	ink-900 #1A1320	ink-700 #3D2E4A	ink-500 #6B5878	ink-300 #A899B5	ink-100 #D9CFE0
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WEBSITE AND MARKETING (LOUD)

coral #FF6B6B Stop, needs you, Michael	mint #6BCF7F Done, good, go	sky #4ECDC4 Thinking, info	lemon #FFD93D Working, highlight	lilac #B197FC Web, integrations	peach #FFA07A Warm highlight
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APP (CALM)

coral #D96A62	mint #5CA97A	sky #4F9FAF	lemon #DCAB3C	lilac #9482D3	peach #D99168
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Text on any colored fill is ink #1A1320. Never pure black or pure white. No gradients.

Color files for design tools are in `colors/`.

Pixel Faces shout. Inter reads.

WEBSITE AND MARKETING

We reviewed Michael.

VT323 • headlines and ALL CAPS labels (tracking .06em)

The software is free.

Pixelify Sans 400 • section headings

A team of AI agents that runs your business, on your own machine.

Inter 400 • everything people read

Pixel faces are never bold and never italic. All five families are free (SIL Open Font License) and included in fonts/.

THE APP

Office Hours

Press Start 2P • small brand labels only, Title Case

Oscar is reconciling March. He needs your OK on two invoices.

Inter 400 to 700 • all UI text, 13 px minimum

> reconcile --month 2026-03

JetBrains Mono • terminal and code

Short, human, a little dry.

ALWAYS

- Name who is acting: "Oscar is reconciling March", never "the agent is processing".
- Keep system messages under 12 words, in second person.
- Aim the joke at Michael, never at the customer.
- Stay honest: no price on a page without prices, no download button before a real release.

NEVER

- Em dashes or en dashes. Use a period, comma, colon or parentheses.
- Emoji in copy.
- Exclamation marks, except for completions and notifications.
- "Dont". Real apostrophes, always.

DON'T WRITE

An error has occurred

Permission denied

Loading...

WRITE

Oscar hit a snag

Oscar needs your permission

One sec...

The same mark, everywhere.



App icon: the mark on a cream tile with rounded corners, which macOS expects. That tile is the only place in the brand with rounded corners. Everything else is square.



08 • WHAT'S IN THIS FOLDER

Grab what you need.

FOLDER	WHAT	USE IT FOR
logo/mark/	The Struck M in SVG, and PNG from 16 to 1024 px. Light, dark, on cream, on ink.	Avatars, stickers, small spaces
logo/lockup/	Mark plus name, horizontal and stacked, light and dark. Text is outlined, so no font is needed.	Headers, slides, documents
app-icon/	App icon: SVG, PNG 128 to 1024, macOS .icns, Windows .ico	Stores, installers, press
web/	Favicons and the Apple touch icon	Websites
social/	1200 × 630 link preview card	Link sharing, social posts
colors/	CSS, JSON, Adobe swatches (.ase), palette image	Design tools and code
fonts/	VT323, Pixelify Sans, Press Start 2P, Inter, JetBrains Mono, each with its license	Installing the brand type
DESIGN.md	The full design system: every token, component and rule	Building product
source/build.py	Regenerates every asset above	Changing the brand

Questions or requests: hello@dontbemichael.com